

Jeremiah 28 - 30

Key Notes, Cross-References, and Messianic Connections (WEB)

Tonight the book turns a corner. For twenty-seven chapters the weight has been almost entirely one direction. Here, at chapter 30, the tone breaks open.

A rival prophet who snaps the yoke off Jeremiah's neck in front of a crowd, and is dead within two months.

A letter carried seven hundred miles to people who had lost everything, telling them to plant gardens.

A promise so often quoted on coffee mugs that we forget it was addressed to refugees with sixty years of exile still ahead of them.

Jeremiah 28 stages the confrontation the whole book has been building toward: two men, both saying "Yahweh says," and only one of them sent.

Jeremiah 29 tells the exiles the last thing they wanted to hear - settle in - and then hands them the reason it is safe to: I know the thoughts that I think toward you.

Jeremiah 30 opens the Book of Consolation, where the wound that was called incurable is healed by the One who inflicted it.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

CHAPTER 28 - Hananiah, the Broken Bar, and the Yoke of Iron

Key Notes

- Hananiah is not an outsider. He is called “the prophet,” he speaks in Yahweh’s house, before the priests and all the people, and he opens with the proper formula: “Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says” (Jeremiah 28:1-2).
- His message is everything a frightened nation wants: the yoke is already broken, the vessels come back, the king comes back, and all of it inside two years (Jeremiah 28:2-4).
- Jeremiah’s first response is the most disarming sentence in the chapter: “Amen! May Yahweh do so.” He genuinely wishes his opponent were right (Jeremiah 28:6).
- Then he lays down the historical test. The prophets before them both prophesied war, evil, and pestilence - the burden of proof sits differently on a man promising peace (Jeremiah 28:7-8).
- The criterion he gives is not a feeling and not a credential: when the word of the prophet happens, then the prophet will be known. Verification is deferred to fulfillment (Jeremiah 28:9).
- Hananiah answers theology with theater. He takes the bar off Jeremiah’s neck and breaks it in front of everyone - a counter-sign, performed on another man’s body (Jeremiah 28:10-11).
- Jeremiah does not retaliate. “Then the prophet Jeremiah went his way.” He leaves the room without a word, and waits for a word (Jeremiah 28:11).
- The word comes, and it is devastating in its economy: you have broken bars of wood, and made in their place bars of iron (Jeremiah 28:13).
- The false comfort did not prevent the yoke. It hardened it. Resistance to a discipline does not cancel the discipline; it changes what the discipline is made of (Jeremiah 28:14).
- The charge against Hananiah is specific and it is pastoral: “you make this people trust in a lie.” The damage named is not doctrinal error but misplaced trust (Jeremiah 28:15).
- The sentence is given with a date, and verse 17 records it landing two months later - the shortest and grimmest fulfillment notice in the book (Jeremiah 28:16-17).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
A Counter-Prophecy in Yahweh’s Name	Jeremiah 28:2 • Jeremiah 27:2 • Jeremiah 14:14
The Vessels That Were Not Coming Back	Jeremiah 28:3 • Jeremiah 27:16 • 2 Kings 24:13
The Test of a Prophet	Jeremiah 28:8-9 • Deuteronomy 18:21-22 • 1 Kings 22:8
Peace Prophesied Where There Is None	Jeremiah 28:9 • Jeremiah 23:16-17 • Ezekiel 13:16
Sign Against Sign	Jeremiah 28:10 • 1 Kings 22:11 • Jeremiah 27:2
Babylon’s Actual Term	Jeremiah 28:11 • Jeremiah 27:7 • Isaiah 47:5-7

Topic	References
A Yoke of Iron	Jeremiah 28:13-14 • Deuteronomy 28:48 • Jeremiah 27:8
Making a People Trust in a Lie	Jeremiah 28:15 • Jeremiah 29:31 • Ezekiel 13:22

Messianic Connections

Connection	References
Wishing Your Opponent Were Right	Jeremiah 28:6 • Matthew 5:44 • Romans 12:14
Known by What Comes to Pass	Jeremiah 28:9 • John 13:19 • Deuteronomy 18:22
Walking Away Without a Word	Jeremiah 28:11 • 1 Peter 2:23 • Isaiah 53:7
A Yoke None of Us Could Bear	Jeremiah 28:14 • Acts 15:10 • Matthew 11:29
Speaking Rebellion Against Yahweh	Jeremiah 28:16 • Deuteronomy 13:5 • Jeremiah 29:32
Swift Judgment on a False Word	Jeremiah 28:17 • Acts 5:5 • 2 Peter 2:1-3

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- [Enduring Word - Jeremiah 28 Commentary \(David Guzik\)](#) - the Hananiah confrontation and the criteria for distinguishing true from false prophecy
- [United Church of God - Beyond Today Bible Commentary, Jeremiah 28](#) - the Deuteronomy 18 test applied to a prophet speaking inside the covenant community
- [Verse By Verse Ministry International - Jeremiah, Lesson 28](#) - exposition of the wooden bars replaced by iron and what that says about resisting discipline

Jeremiah 28 - Opening Intro

The thing to understand about Hananiah is that nothing about him looked wrong.

He was a prophet by title. He spoke in the temple, in front of the priests, with the whole congregation present. He used the correct formula. His message was patriotic, hopeful, and specific - two years, and this is over. And he was, as far as we can tell, sincere.

That is what makes this chapter uncomfortable. There was no external marker separating him from Jeremiah. Same venue, same vocabulary, same God invoked, opposite messages.

Watch what Jeremiah does with that. He does not sneer. His first word is “Amen” - and he means it. “May Yahweh do so. May Yahweh perform your words.” A man who had been beaten, jailed, and boycotted for twenty years still wanted the good news to be true.

Then he offers the only test available, and it is a hard one: wait. The prophet who promises peace is known when the peace arrives. There is no shortcut, no credential, no anointing that substitutes for time.

And Hananiah cannot wait. He grabs the yoke off Jeremiah's neck and snaps it - a counter-sign performed on someone else's body, which is its own kind of tell. Jeremiah says nothing at all and walks out. He has no word yet, so he does not manufacture one. That silence is a discipline most of us have never practiced.

The word, when it comes, is the sentence to carry out of this chapter: you have broken bars of wood, and made in their place bars of iron. The comfortable message did not remove the yoke. It upgraded it.

Before we read, hold this gently but hold it: the danger of a false word is almost never that it sounds false. It is that it sounds like exactly what we hoped, delivered by someone with every credential we know how to check.

Jeremiah 28:1-17 (WEB)

1 That same year, in the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah, in the fourth year, in the fifth month, Hananiah the son of Azzur, the prophet, who was of Gibeon, spoke to me in Yahweh's house, in the presence of the priests and of all the people, saying,

2 "Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says, 'I have broken the yoke of the king of Babylon.'¹

3 Within two full years will I bring again into this place all the vessels of Yahweh's house, that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon took away from this place, and carried to Babylon.²

4 I will bring again to this place Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim, king of Judah, with all the captives of Judah, who went to Babylon,' says Yahweh; 'for I will break the yoke of the king of Babylon.'"

5 Then the prophet Jeremiah said to the prophet Hananiah in the presence of the priests, and in the presence of all the people who stood in Yahweh's house,

6 even the prophet Jeremiah said, "Amen! May Yahweh do so. May Yahweh perform your words which you have prophesied, to bring again the vessels of Yahweh's house, and all those who are captives, from Babylon to this place."³

7 Nevertheless listen now to this word that I speak in your ears, and in the ears of all the people:

¹ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 27:2](#) • [Jeremiah 14:14](#) - the yoke Jeremiah was told to wear, and prophets who prophesy the deceit of their own heart

² **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 27:16](#) • [2 Kings 24:13](#) - the vessels already in Babylon, and the lie circulating that they would shortly return

³ **Messianic Connection:** [Matthew 5:44](#) • [Romans 12:14](#) - the posture of blessing rather than cursing, even toward the man contradicting you in public

8 The prophets who have been before me and before you of old prophesied against many countries, and against great kingdoms, of war, of evil, and of pestilence.⁴

9 The prophet who prophesies of peace, when the word of the prophet happens, then the prophet will be known, that Yahweh has truly sent him.”⁵

10 Then Hananiah the prophet took the bar from off the prophet Jeremiah’s neck, and broke it.⁶

11 Hananiah spoke in the presence of all the people, saying, “Yahweh says: ‘Even so I will break the yoke of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon from off the neck of all the nations within two full years.’” Then the prophet Jeremiah went his way.⁷

12 Then Yahweh’s word came to Jeremiah, after Hananiah the prophet had broken the bar from off the neck of the prophet Jeremiah, saying,

13 “Go, and tell Hananiah, saying, ‘Yahweh says, “You have broken the bars of wood, but you have made in their place bars of iron.”’^{8,9}

14 For Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel says, “I have put a yoke of iron on the neck of all these nations, that they may serve Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon; and they will serve him. I have also given him the animals of the field.””

15 Then the prophet Jeremiah said to Hananiah the prophet, “Listen, Hananiah! Yahweh has not sent you, but you make this people trust in a lie.”¹⁰

16 Therefore Yahweh says, ‘Behold, I will send you away from off the surface of the earth. This year you will die, because you have spoken rebellion against Yahweh.’”¹¹

17 So Hananiah the prophet died the same year in the seventh month.¹²

⁴ **Cross-Reference:** [Deuteronomy 18:21-22](#) • [1 Kings 22:8](#) - the Torah’s test for a prophet, and a king who hated Micaiah for never prophesying good

⁵ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 23:16-17](#) • [Ezekiel 13:16](#) - visions of peace announced to a city where there was no peace

⁶ **Cross-Reference:** [1 Kings 22:11](#) • [Jeremiah 27:2](#) - iron horns made as a counter-sign - dramatic gestures are not proof of a sending

⁷ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 27:7](#) • [Isaiah 47:5-7](#) - three generations of Babylonian rule, and a mistress of kingdoms sure she would reign forever

⁸ **Cross-Reference:** [Deuteronomy 28:48](#) • [Jeremiah 27:8](#) - a yoke of iron on the neck, named in the covenant curses long before Babylon existed

⁹ **Messianic Connection:** [Acts 15:10](#) • [Matthew 11:29](#) - a yoke neither we nor our fathers could bear, and the one He calls easy

¹⁰ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 29:31](#) • [Ezekiel 13:22](#) - causing a people to trust in a lie, and strengthening the hands of the wicked with false comfort

¹¹ **Cross-Reference:** [Deuteronomy 13:5](#) • [Jeremiah 29:32](#) - the Torah’s sentence for a prophet who speaks turning-away against Yahweh

¹² **Messianic Connection:** [Acts 5:5](#) • [2 Peter 2:1-3](#) - swift judgment inside the assembly, and false teachers bringing destruction on themselves

CHAPTER 29 - The Letter to Babylon

Key Notes

- This is a real letter, carried by named couriers on a diplomatic mission - Elasah son of Shaphan and Gemariah son of Hilkiyah, traveling to Babylon on Zedekiah's business (Jeremiah 29:1-3).
- The recipients are the 597 deportees: elders, priests, prophets, and the people taken with Jeconiah - the same group chapter 24 called the good figs (Jeremiah 29:1-2).
- The instructions are almost aggressively ordinary. Build houses. Live in them. Plant gardens. Eat what grows. Marry, and let your children marry (Jeremiah 29:5-6).
- "Multiply there, and don't be diminished" is a deliberate echo of Genesis. Exile is not a suspension of the creation mandate (Jeremiah 29:6).
- Then the astonishing command: seek the peace of the city that took you captive, and pray for it - because your welfare is bound up in its welfare (Jeremiah 29:7).
- The warning that follows is the reason the letter was needed. Prophets in Babylon were promising a quick return, and people were living out of suitcases because of it (Jeremiah 29:8-9).
- The timeline is restated: seventy years for Babylon, and then "I will visit you and perform my good word toward you." The promise has a schedule (Jeremiah 29:10).
- Verse 11 is spoken to people who will die in Babylon. "Thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you hope and a future" is not a promise of comfort now, but of a future secured (Jeremiah 29:11).
- The conditions that follow are relational, not transactional: call on me, pray, seek me - and the qualifier is total, "when you search for me with all your heart" (Jeremiah 29:12-13).
- Those still in Jerusalem, congratulating themselves on not having been deported, are told they are the rotten figs - sword, famine, pestilence (Jeremiah 29:15-19).
- Two named false prophets in Babylon, Ahab and Zedekiah, are exposed for adultery and lying in Yahweh's name, and Yahweh says simply: "I am he who knows, and am witness" (Jeremiah 29:21-23).
- Shemaiah writes his own letter demanding Jeremiah be put in the stocks - and is answered with a sentence that stings more than punishment: he will not see the good I will do for my people (Jeremiah 29:24-32).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Build, Plant, Marry, Multiply	Jeremiah 29:5-6 • Jeremiah 24:5-6 • Genesis 39:2-3
Pray for the City That Holds You	Jeremiah 29:7 • Ezra 6:10 • 1 Timothy 2:1-2
Don't Let Them Deceive You	Jeremiah 29:8 • Jeremiah 27:9 • Colossians 2:8
Seventy Years Completed	Jeremiah 29:10 • 2 Chronicles 36:22-23 • Daniel 9:2

Topic	References
The Thoughts He Thinks Toward Us	Jeremiah 29:11 • Isaiah 55:8-9 • Psalm 40:5
Sought With the Whole Heart	Jeremiah 29:13 • Deuteronomy 4:29 • 2 Chronicles 15:2
The Rotten Figs Left Behind	Jeremiah 29:17 • Jeremiah 24:8-10 • Jeremiah 21:9
"I Am He Who Knows, and Am Witness"	Jeremiah 29:23 • Jeremiah 23:14 • Hebrews 4:13

Messianic Connections

Connection	References
Sojourners Whose Citizenship Is Elsewhere	Jeremiah 29:7 • 1 Peter 2:11-12 • Philippians 3:20
A Future Secured by His Intention	Jeremiah 29:11 • Romans 8:28 • John 10:10
Seek and You Will Find	Jeremiah 29:13 • Matthew 7:7-8 • Acts 17:27
Gathered From All the Places He Drove Us	Jeremiah 29:14 • John 11:52 • Ephesians 2:13
The One Who Knows and Bears Witness	Jeremiah 29:23 • Revelation 2:23 • John 2:24-25
Missing the Good He Will Do	Jeremiah 29:32 • Hebrews 3:19 • Numbers 14:23

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- [Enduring Word - Jeremiah 29 Commentary \(David Guzik\)](#) - the letter to the exiles read in its actual setting, including verse 11 in context
- [United Church of God - Beyond Today Bible Commentary, Jeremiah 29](#) - seeking the peace of the city, and the covenant promise of return after seventy years
- [Verse By Verse Ministry International - Jeremiah, Lesson 29](#) - careful handling of Jeremiah 29:11 and who it was actually addressed to

Jeremiah 29 - Opening Intro

Verse 11 has been printed on more graduation cards than any other sentence in this book, and almost none of them mention who was holding the letter.

The recipients had watched their city looted. They had walked to Babylon in a column. Their king was in a foreign prison. Most of the people reading that letter would die without seeing Jerusalem again - seventy years is longer than a life in the ancient world. That is the audience for "thoughts of peace, and not of evil."

Which does not make the promise smaller. It makes it sturdier. It is not a promise that this year will go well. It is a promise that the trajectory is not abandonment, spoken to people with every reason to believe otherwise.

And look at what He actually asks of them in the meantime. Build houses. Plant gardens. Have children and grandchildren. Multiply - the Genesis word - there. Not: hold on, keep your bags packed, this is temporary. He tells them to sink roots into the soil of the place that took everything from them.

Then verse 7, which is one of the most remarkable instructions in the Old Testament: seek the shalom of the city where I sent you into captivity, and pray to Yahweh for it. Pray for Babylon. Not against it - for it. Because in its peace you will have peace.

There is a pastoral reason underneath all of it. Prophets in Babylon were promising an imminent return, and people were refusing to plant anything because they expected to leave. False hope had made a whole community unable to live. Sometimes the kindest word God gives is the one that ends the waiting and lets you start your life.

Before we read, notice the order in verses 12 and 13. Call, pray, seek - and then “you shall seek me, and find me, when you search for me with all your heart.” The finding is promised. The condition is that we stop looking for Him with only part of ourselves.

Jeremiah 29:1-32 (WEB)

1 Now these are the words of the letter that Jeremiah the prophet sent from Jerusalem to the residue of the elders of the captivity, and to the priests, to the prophets, and to all the people whom Nebuchadnezzar had carried away captive from Jerusalem to Babylon,

2 (after Jeconiah the king, the queen mother, the eunuchs, the princes of Judah and Jerusalem, the craftsmen, and the smiths, had departed from Jerusalem),

3 by the hand of Elasah the son of Shaphan, and Gemariah the son of Hilkiah, (whom Zedekiah king of Judah sent to Babylon to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon). It said:

4 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says to all the captives whom I have caused to be carried away captive from Jerusalem to Babylon:

5 “Build houses and dwell in them. Plant gardens and eat their fruit.”¹³

6 Take wives and father sons and daughters. Take wives for your sons, and give your daughters to husbands, that they may bear sons and daughters. Multiply there, and don’t be diminished.

¹³ Cross-Reference: [Jeremiah 24:5-6](#) • [Genesis 39:2-3](#) - the exiles regarded for good, and a man prospering in a foreign house because Yahweh was with him

7 Seek the peace of the city where I have caused you to be carried away captive, and pray to Yahweh for it; for in its peace you will have peace.”^{14,15}

8 For Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel says: “Don’t let your prophets who are among you and your diviners deceive you. Don’t listen to your dreams which you cause to be dreamed.”¹⁶

9 For they prophesy falsely to you in my name. I have not sent them,” says Yahweh.

10 For Yahweh says, “After seventy years are accomplished for Babylon, I will visit you and perform my good word toward you, in causing you to return to this place.”¹⁷

11 For I know the thoughts that I think toward you,” says Yahweh, “thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you hope and a future.”^{18,19}

12 You shall call on me, and you shall go and pray to me, and I will listen to you.

13 You shall seek me, and find me, when you search for me with all your heart.”^{20,21}

14 I will be found by you,” says Yahweh, “and I will turn again your captivity, and I will gather you from all the nations, and from all the places where I have driven you, says Yahweh. I will bring you again to the place from where I caused you to be carried away captive.”

15 Because you have said, “Yahweh has raised us up prophets in Babylon;”

16 Yahweh says concerning the king who sits on David’s throne, and concerning all the people who dwell in this city, your brothers who haven’t gone with you into captivity;

17 Yahweh of Armies says: “Behold, I will send on them the sword, the famine, and the pestilence, and will make them like rotten figs that can’t be eaten, they are so bad.”²²

18 I will pursue after them with the sword, with the famine, and with the pestilence, and will deliver them to be tossed back and forth among all the kingdoms of the earth, to be an object of horror, an astonishment, a hissing, and a reproach among all the nations where I have driven them,

¹⁴ **Cross-Reference:** [Ezra 6:10](#) • [1 Timothy 2:1-2](#) - prayer offered for the life of the king, that we may lead quiet and peaceable lives

¹⁵ **Messianic Connection:** [1 Peter 2:11-12](#) • [Philippians 3:20](#) - sojourners and exiles living honorably among the nations, with citizenship in heaven

¹⁶ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 27:9](#) • [Colossians 2:8](#) - diviners and dreamers then, and hollow deceit after human tradition now

¹⁷ **Cross-Reference:** [2 Chronicles 36:22-23](#) • [Daniel 9:2](#) - the seventy years fulfilled in Cyrus’s decree, and Daniel praying because he read this verse

¹⁸ **Cross-Reference:** [Isaiah 55:8-9](#) • [Psalm 40:5](#) - thoughts higher than ours, too many to be counted, all of them toward us

¹⁹ **Messianic Connection:** [Romans 8:28](#) • [John 10:10](#) - all things worked together for good, and life offered abundantly

²⁰ **Cross-Reference:** [Deuteronomy 4:29](#) • [2 Chronicles 15:2](#) - seeking Him from exile with all the heart, and the promise that He is found by those who seek

²¹ **Messianic Connection:** [Matthew 7:7-8](#) • [Acts 17:27](#) - seek and you will find, for He is not far from any one of us

²² **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 24:8-10](#) • [Jeremiah 21:9](#) - the bad figs of the earlier vision - those who stayed behind and thought that proved something

19 because they have not listened to my words,” says Yahweh, “with which I sent to them my servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them; but you would not hear,” says Yahweh.

20 Hear therefore Yahweh’s word, all you captives, whom I have sent away from Jerusalem to Babylon.

21 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says concerning Ahab the son of Kolaiah, and concerning Zedekiah the son of Maaseiah, who prophesy a lie to you in my name: “Behold, I will deliver them into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon; and he will kill them before your eyes.

22 A curse will be taken up about them by all the captives of Judah who are in Babylon, saying, ‘Yahweh make you like Zedekiah and like Ahab, whom the king of Babylon roasted in the fire;’

23 because they have done foolish things in Israel, and have committed adultery with their neighbors’ wives, and have spoken words in my name falsely, which I didn’t command them. I am he who knows, and am witness,” says Yahweh.²³

24 Concerning Shemaiah the Nehelamite you shall speak, saying,

25 “Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says, ‘Because you have sent letters in your own name to all the people who are at Jerusalem, and to Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah, the priest, and to all the priests, saying,

26 “Yahweh has made you priest in the place of Jehoiada the priest, that there may be officers in Yahweh’s house, for every man who is crazy, and makes himself a prophet, that you should put him in the stocks and in shackles.

27 Now therefore, why have you not rebuked Jeremiah of Anathoth, who makes himself a prophet to you,

28 because he has sent to us in Babylon, saying, The captivity is long. Build houses, and dwell in them. Plant gardens, and eat their fruit?’”

29 Zephaniah the priest read this letter in the hearing of Jeremiah the prophet.

30 Then Yahweh’s word came to Jeremiah, saying,

31 “Send to all of the captives, saying, ‘Yahweh says concerning Shemaiah the Nehelamite: “Because Shemaiah has prophesied to you, and I didn’t send him, and he has caused you to trust in a lie;”

32 therefore Yahweh says, “Behold, I will punish Shemaiah the Nehelamite and his offspring. He will not have a man to dwell among this people. He won’t see the good that I will do to my people,” says Yahweh, “because he has spoken rebellion against Yahweh.””²⁴

²³ Cross-Reference: [Jeremiah 23:14](#) • [Hebrews 4:13](#) - adultery and lies among the prophets, before the eyes of the One from whom nothing is hidden

²⁴ Cross-Reference: [Jeremiah 28:16](#) • [Numbers 14:23](#) - the same sentence twice over - he will not see the good land, nor the good I will do

CHAPTER 30 - Jacob's Trouble and the Wound That Gets Healed

Key Notes

- Chapters 30 through 33 are usually called the Book of Consolation, and this one opens with a publishing order: write all the words I have spoken to you in a book (Jeremiah 30:1-2).
- The scope is deliberately wide - "my people Israel and Judah." The northern kingdom, gone for a century, is included in the restoration (Jeremiah 30:3-4).
- The chapter does not skip the pain to get to the promise. It opens with trembling, fear, and men doubled over with their hands on their waists like women in labor (Jeremiah 30:5-6).
- "It is even the time of Jacob's trouble; but he will be saved out of it." Both halves of that verse matter, and the second half is the point (Jeremiah 30:7).
- The yoke that dominated chapters 27 and 28 is finally broken - not by a Hananiah snapping a bar, but by Yahweh in His own appointed day (Jeremiah 30:8).
- The restored people will serve "Yahweh their God, and David their king, whom I will raise up to them" - written four centuries after David died (Jeremiah 30:9).
- The discipline is bounded on both sides: a full end of the nations, but not of you; correction in measure, and yet not left unpunished (Jeremiah 30:10-11).
- Then the diagnosis returns in its bluntest form - incurable hurt, a grievous wound, no one to plead the cause, no healing medicines, and lovers who have forgotten (Jeremiah 30:12-14).
- Yahweh takes responsibility for the wound without apologizing for it: "I have wounded you with the wound of an enemy" - and the reason given is the greatness of their iniquity (Jeremiah 30:14-15).
- And then the turn, on one word: "Therefore." Therefore the devourers are devoured, the plunderers become plunder, and the incurable wound is healed by the One who gave it (Jeremiah 30:16-17).
- The reason given for the healing is almost tender: "because they have called you an outcast, saying, It is Zion, whom no man seeks after." He acts because no one else would (Jeremiah 30:17).
- The restoration is domestic and specific - tents, dwelling places, a city rebuilt on its own ruin-heap, thanksgiving, laughter, children, a congregation established (Jeremiah 30:18-20).
- Verse 21 asks a question the whole Bible is answering: their ruler will come from among them and approach Yahweh - "for who is he who has had boldness to approach to me?" (Jeremiah 30:21).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Write It in a Book	Jeremiah 30:2 • Jeremiah 36:2 • Isaiah 30:8
The Time of Jacob's Trouble	Jeremiah 30:7 • Daniel 12:1 • Joel 2:11
The Yoke Broken at Last	Jeremiah 30:8 • Isaiah 9:4 • Isaiah 10:27

Topic	References
David Their King Raised Up	Jeremiah 30:9 • Hosea 3:5 • Ezekiel 37:24
Corrected in Measure, Not Consumed	Jeremiah 30:11 • Amos 9:8 • Isaiah 27:8
An Incurable Wound	Jeremiah 30:12 • Jeremiah 15:18 • Isaiah 1:6
Yahweh Who Heals	Jeremiah 30:17 • Exodus 15:26 • Hosea 6:1
My People, and I Their God	Jeremiah 30:22 • Leviticus 26:12 • Jeremiah 31:33

Messianic Connections

Connection	References
Saved Out of the Great Tribulation	Jeremiah 30:7 • Matthew 24:21-22 • Romans 11:26
The Davidic King Raised Up	Jeremiah 30:9 • Hosea 3:5 • Luke 1:32-33
Healed by the Wounds of Another	Jeremiah 30:17 • Isaiah 53:5 • 1 Peter 2:24
A Ruler From Among Them Who Draws Near	Jeremiah 30:21 • Hebrews 7:26-27 • Hebrews 10:19-22
The Dwelling of God With Men	Jeremiah 30:22 • 2 Corinthians 6:16 • Revelation 21:3
Understood in the Latter Days	Jeremiah 30:24 • Jeremiah 23:20 • Deuteronomy 4:30

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- [Enduring Word - Jeremiah 30 Commentary \(David Guzik\)](#) - the opening of the Book of Consolation and the time of Jacob's trouble
- [United Church of God - Beyond Today Bible Commentary, Jeremiah 30](#) - the restoration of both Israel and Judah and the raising up of David their king
- [Verse By Verse Ministry International - Jeremiah, Lesson 30](#) - exposition of the incurable wound healed and the ruler who approaches Yahweh in verse 21

Jeremiah 30 - Opening Intro

Twenty-nine chapters of demolition, and then a publishing order. Write it in a book. Something is about to be said that Yahweh wants preserved in permanent form.

What follows in chapters 30 through 33 is the most sustained comfort in Jeremiah, and this chapter sets the pattern: it does not get to the comfort by going around the pain. It goes straight through it.

Verse 6 is a strange, vivid image - men doubled over with their hands on their lower backs, faces gone pale, in the posture of a woman in labor. It is the prophet reaching for the only comparison violent enough. And labor is not an accidental metaphor. It is agony that produces something.

“The time of Jacob’s trouble” has become a technical phrase in a lot of prophetic teaching, and readers disagree about how far forward it reaches. What no one can miss is the clause attached to it: but he will be saved out of it. The trouble is named and bounded in the same breath.

Then comes the passage that makes this chapter unforgettable. Verses 12 through 15 are as bleak as anything in the book - your hurt is incurable, no one pleads your cause, you have no medicines, your lovers have forgotten you - and Yahweh takes responsibility for the wound. I did this. I struck you like an enemy would.

And then verse 16 begins with one word: Therefore. Not “nevertheless.” Not “but.” Therefore. Because your wound is incurable and no one else will bind it, therefore I will restore health to you and heal you of your wounds. The hopelessness of the case is the reason He acts, not the obstacle to it.

And His stated motive is worth carrying: because they called you an outcast, Zion whom no man seeks after. He moves toward the one nobody was coming for.

Before we read, hold verse 21 and let it sit unanswered for a while. “Who is he who has had boldness to approach to me?” Jeremiah does not name him. But he tells us the man will come from among his own people, and that Yahweh Himself will cause him to draw near.

Jeremiah 30:1-24 (WEB)

1 The word that came to Jeremiah from Yahweh, saying,

2 “Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, ‘Write all the words that I have spoken to you in a book.’²⁵

3 For, behold, the days come,’ says Yahweh, ‘that I will reverse the captivity of my people Israel and Judah,’ says Yahweh. ‘I will cause them to return to the land that I gave to their fathers, and they will possess it.’”

4 These are the words that Yahweh spoke concerning Israel and concerning Judah.

5 For Yahweh says: “We have heard a voice of trembling; a voice of fear, and not of peace.

6 Ask now, and see whether a man travails with child. Why do I see every man with his hands on his waist, as a woman in travail, and all faces are turned pale?

7 Alas! for that day is great, so that none is like it. It is even the time of Jacob’s trouble; but he will be saved out of it.^{26,27}

8 It will come to pass in that day, says Yahweh of Armies, that I will break his yoke from off your neck, and will burst your bonds. Strangers will no more make them their bondservants;

²⁵ Cross-Reference: [Jeremiah 36:2](#) • [Isaiah 30:8](#) - the word committed to writing so it outlasts the generation that first refused it

²⁶ Cross-Reference: [Daniel 12:1](#) • [Joel 2:11](#) - a time of trouble such as never was, and a day so great that none can endure it

²⁷ Messianic Connection: [Matthew 24:21-22](#) • [Romans 11:26](#) - days cut short for the elect’s sake, and the Deliverer who comes out of Zion

9 but they will serve Yahweh their God, and David their king, whom I will raise up to them.²⁸

10 Therefore don't be afraid, O Jacob my servant, says Yahweh. Don't be dismayed, Israel. For, behold, I will save you from afar, and save your offspring from the land of their captivity. Jacob will return, and will be quiet and at ease. No one will make him afraid.

11 For I am with you, says Yahweh, to save you; for I will make a full end of all the nations where I have scattered you, but I will not make a full end of you; but I will correct you in measure, and will in no way leave you unpunished."²⁹

12 For Yahweh says, "Your hurt is incurable. Your wound is grievous."^{30,31}

13 There is no one to plead your cause, that you may be bound up. You have no healing medicines.

14 All your lovers have forgotten you. They don't seek you. For I have wounded you with the wound of an enemy, with the chastisement of a cruel one, for the greatness of your iniquity, because your sins were increased.

15 Why do you cry over your injury? Your pain is incurable. For the greatness of your iniquity, because your sins have increased, I have done these things to you.

16 Therefore all those who devour you will be devoured. All your adversaries, everyone of them, will go into captivity. Those who plunder you will be plunder. I will make all who prey on you become prey.

17 For I will restore health to you, and I will heal you of your wounds," says Yahweh; "because they have called you an outcast, saying, 'It is Zion, whom no man seeks after.'"³²

18 Yahweh says: "Behold, I will reverse the captivity of Jacob's tents, and have compassion on his dwelling places. The city will be built on its own hill, and the palace will be inhabited in its own place.

19 Thanksgiving will proceed out of them with the voice of those who make merry. I will multiply them, and they will not be few; I will also glorify them, and they will not be small.

20 Their children also will be as before, and their congregation will be established before me. I will punish all who oppress them.

²⁸ **Messianic Connection:** [Hosea 3:5](#) • [Luke 1:32-33](#) - Israel seeking Yahweh and David their king in the latter days - a throne without end

²⁹ **Cross-Reference:** [Amos 9:8](#) • [Isaiah 27:8](#) - the kingdom destroyed yet the house of Jacob not utterly destroyed, corrected in measure

³⁰ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 15:18](#) • [Isaiah 1:6](#) - the incurable wound Jeremiah once charged God with, now spoken by God over His own people

³¹ **Messianic Connection:** [Isaiah 53:5](#) • [1 Peter 2:24](#) - the wound that heals - by His stripes we are healed

³² **Cross-Reference:** [Exodus 15:26](#) • [Hosea 6:1](#) - Yahweh who heals, who tore and will heal, who struck and will bind up

21 Their prince will be one of them, and their ruler will proceed from among them. I will cause him to draw near, and he will approach to me; for who is he who has had boldness to approach to me?" says Yahweh.³³

22 "You shall be my people, and I will be your God."^{34,35}

23 Behold, Yahweh's storm, his wrath, has gone out, a sweeping storm: it will burst on the head of the wicked.

24 The fierce anger of Yahweh will not return until he has accomplished, and until he has performed the intentions of his heart. In the latter days you will understand it."³⁶

³³ **Messianic Connection:** [Hebrews 7:26-27](#) • [Hebrews 10:19-22](#) - a high priest taken from among men, and boldness given us to enter the holy place

³⁴ **Cross-Reference:** [Leviticus 26:12](#) • [Jeremiah 31:33](#) - the covenant formula standing from Sinai through the new covenant

³⁵ **Messianic Connection:** [2 Corinthians 6:16](#) • [Revelation 21:3](#) - God dwelling among His people, and the tabernacle of God finally with men

³⁶ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 23:20](#) • [Deuteronomy 4:30](#) - understanding withheld until the latter days, when they turn and obey His voice

Major Themes Across Jeremiah 28-30

- False comfort that looks identical to the real thing - same venue, same formula, same God invoked
- Fulfillment as the only test of a peace-prophecy, and the discipline of waiting for it
- Resistance that hardens discipline rather than removing it: wooden bars replaced with iron
- Trust as the thing at stake - the charge is not error but making a people trust in a lie
- Ordinary faithfulness in exile: build, plant, marry, multiply, and pray for the city that took you
- A promise of a future spoken to people who would not live to see it, and sturdier for that
- Grace upstream of return - He is found by those who seek with the whole heart, and He promises to be found
- Circumstances misread again: the deported were the good figs, the ones left behind were not
- Pain not skipped on the way to comfort - labor pains, and a trouble named and bounded in one breath
- "Therefore" as the hinge of the gospel: the wound's incurability is the reason He heals it

Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May the God who tells the truth when a lie would be more welcome give us ears that can bear it, and may we love a hard word from Him more than a soft word from anyone else.

May we be slow to break the yokes His hand has placed, knowing that wood refused becomes iron.

May He give us grace to live where He has actually put us - to build, to plant, to raise children, to seek the peace of a city we did not choose - instead of waiting out our lives for a rescue on our own timetable.

May we seek Him with the whole heart and not a portion of it, and may He keep His promise to be found.

May we trust His thoughts toward us when our circumstances argue otherwise, and believe that the trajectory is peace even when the season is not.

May He heal what has been called incurable, and may the very hopelessness of our case become the reason He moves.

And when no one is seeking after us, when we are called outcast and nobody comes, may we remember that this is precisely the condition He named before He said: I will restore health to you.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.